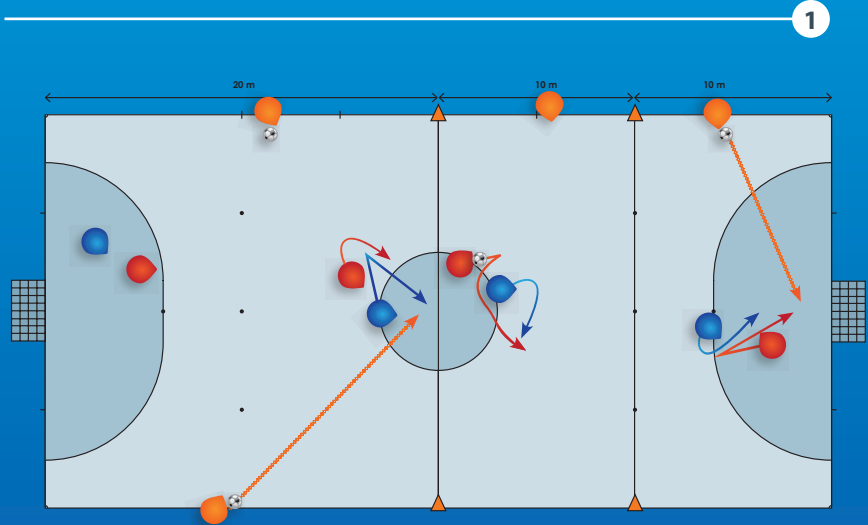


Individual marking drill



LEARNING UNIT
Individual technical/tactical options.

PHASE
Beginners.

CONTENT
Individual aspects of marking.

OBJECTIVES
To introduce the players to individual elements and aspects of marking and how to defend against an attacking player before and after they receive the ball.

NUMBER OF PLAYERS
12.

EQUIPMENT
Balls, bibs and cones.

DRILL DESCRIPTION

- The court is divided into three zones, as shown in the diagram; two at 10x20m and one at 20x20m.
- In the 10x20m zones, play a 1v1 (with one player outside the zone) where the attacker tries to receive the ball from that player. Whenever the ball goes out of play, it must be played back in by the player outside the

zone. The objective for the attacker is to get to the opposite line from which the ball was delivered, while controlling the ball. The defender must try to prevent the attacker from receiving the ball, or if they do receive it, to prevent them from advancing to the other side of the zone. If the defender regains the ball, they must pass it to the player outside of the zone, in order to become the attacker and try to receive the pass.

- In the 20x20m zone, a 2v2 is played with two players outside the zone (one for each team), with the same routine as before. Halfway through the exercise, a new rule is introduced, whereby both the attacking players have to touch the ball before looking to cross the line. Every time the defending team regains possession, they play the ball to their player outside the zone.
- Coaches must correct aspects of individual marking before and after the attacker has received the ball.
- Players outside the zone swap with players inside it at set intervals or based on rules that require rotation in specific circumstances.

in the first line in pressing the ball, the idea here being for them to switch opponents, provide possible cover and rotate if necessary. The player in the second line on the side opposite to the player in possession is known as the defensive **opposite wing**. The positioning in a **defensive triangle** of the players in the first line of defence and the opposite wing is a tactic that is commonly used. These players try to make use of the greatest possible number of defensive **lines of pressure**, creating an organised system which provides support and defensive cover and enables defenders to control the space effectively.

5. **Core teamwork concepts**
The key core concepts of teamwork in small-group tactics are: **support** (an action taken by a defender to halt the progress of an attacker who has broken clear of a team-mate and which enables said team-mate to recover their position; **covering** (where a player takes up a position or makes themselves available to help a team-mate who could be about to lose the player they are marking); **switching** (occupying the position of the team-mate providing cover after an opponent has broken clear).
6. **Buying time**
This is an action designed to check the progress of an attacking player so that the defence has more time in which to regain position.
7. **Floating cover**
This is a defensive resource in which a defender floats away from a particular attacker (the player being marked) so that they can then intervene in a different situation, waiting for the right moment to select the correct defensive action.
8. **Markers switching opponents**
Defenders may swap the opponents that they are marking in a game situation where they are looking to maintain a particular defensive shape

in response to an opposition attack. The objective here is to maintain the defensive lines; prevent the opposition from creating passing angles; stop the opposition from moving the ball around; close off passing angles; maintain pressure on the ball; and make it difficult for the opposition to support the player in possession, etc.

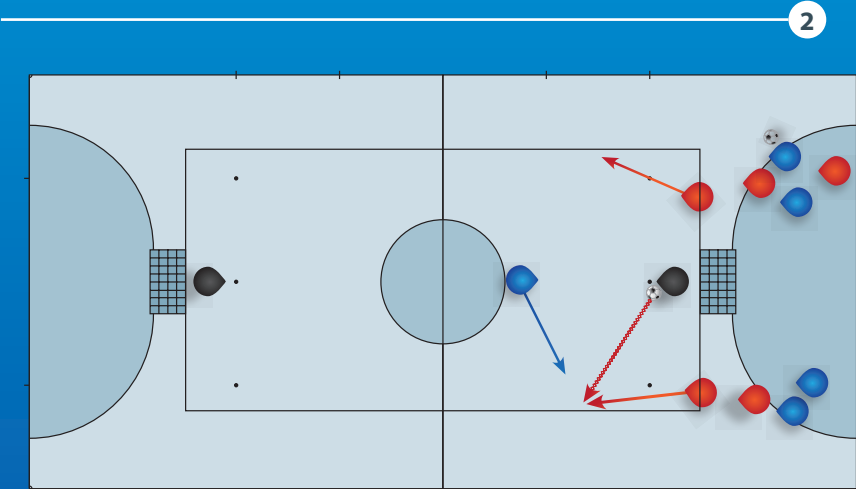
There are many different scenarios where defenders may choose to swap marking duties, but we will highlight just three:

- Swapping opponents to mark with a team-mate (opposition players without possession).
- Switching markers to restrict passing angles between opposing players (closing the angle).
- Variation of space when switching markers.

9. **'Jumping'**
In practice, this core concept entails the switching of opponents, although it also involves other distinguishing characteristics, the most important of them being that in a situation where there are two defenders covering two attacking players, one of which is on the ball, the defenders switch attackers when the attacker on the ball plays it to the other attacker. The defender covering the attacker playing the pass then 'jumps' over to cover the attacker receiving the pass, with the other defender then covering the attacking player who has just passed the ball.

10. **Closing/blocking the passing angles**
There are two different ways to block or close down a passing angle: close down the passing angles available to the player in possession (defensive positioning, pressing the ball and controlling the space) or close down the passing angles available to players not in possession (blocking the angles, anticipating the pass, etc.).

A defensive 1v2 with no restrictions on spatial dimensions once the attacking team has made six passes; finish into one of the two goals



LEARNING UNIT
Core defensive concepts.

PHASE
Skills acquisition.

CONTENT
Controlling space. Visual command of the playing area and command of peripheral vision. Movement. Defensive feints. Reading attacking positioning, etc.

OBJECTIVES
To improve certain core defensive concepts when playing at a numerical disadvantage of 1v2. Special emphasis on improving visual command of the playing area.

NUMBER OF PLAYERS
10 plus goalkeepers.

EQUIPMENT
Balls and bibs.

DRILL DESCRIPTION

- As the diagram shows, a 1v2 scenario is played out on half a basketball court until the two attacking players pass the ball six times between each other, at which point we open up the whole of the playing area, giving the attackers the freedom to finish in either of the goals.
- They are not allowed to change the direction in which they are attacking by switching from one half to the other. Once the attackers take the ball into one of the courts, they cannot then change direction and head for the other goal.
- A player finishing on goal becomes the defender for the next drill.